Sixfold

RIDGE, AERATED — CORE TREATMENTS

One mark, four ways of drawing the core. The spacing, the depths and everything above the ground line are identical in all four — the only variable is the core itself, so the comparison is fair. Nothing here is a master file yet.

WHERE THIS GOT TO

The board carried six competing concepts. It now carries one. **"Ridge, aerated" is the candidate** and the remaining question is how the cores are drawn. The other five are retired rather than binned — they are in the repository history if anyone wants them back.

What is settled and not up for grabs in this round:

- **Five forms, five cores.** The Ridge mark has four peaks and one conifer above the ground line. One core per form, directly beneath it.
- **Each core is as deep as its form is tall.** Apex heights measured off the path data: `30.5 / 38 / 48 / 60 / 72`. The bottom edge is the skyline inverted.
- **The turf band and its five holes.** The holes are what a hollow tine leaves.
- **The ember is the conifer's core** — the one form that is not a peak, and the smallest of the five.

> **Every treatment below keeps a lid of turf in the band's own colour.** That is not decoration: a plug comes out of the ground with the lawn still attached, and it is the one feature that says "aeration core" rather than "shape". It takes the band colour because it is the same turf. An earlier attempt put a Sage cap on a Moss body — `1.20:1`, separated by hue alone — and it did not read at all.

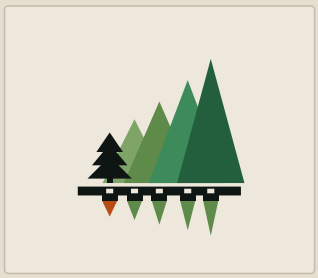
THE FOUR

01 Mirror wedge

CORE TREATMENT 1 OF 4



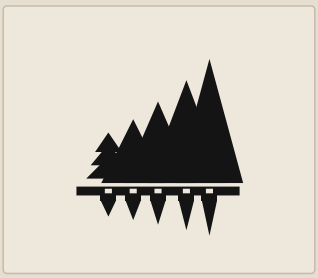
PINE GROUND



BONE GROUND



TONAL GREY



ONE INK — NO TONES

WHAT IT IS

Each core is the form above it turned upside down. The mirror stops being a measurement and becomes the shape.

WHAT IT COSTS

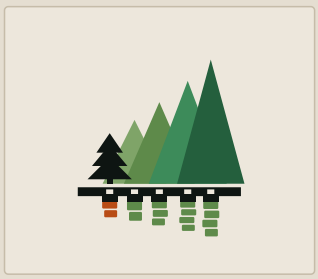
Purely geometric. It is the cleanest of the four and the strongest at small size, but nothing about a wedge says *soil* — it reads as reflection, not as a plug.

02 Broken plug

CORE TREATMENT 2 OF 4



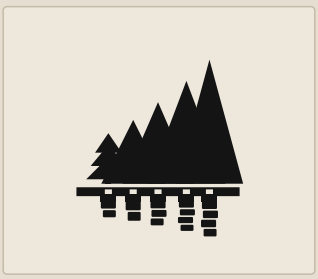
PINE GROUND



BONE GROUND



TONAL GREY



ONE INK — NO TONES

WHAT IT IS

The core in pieces, two to four depending on its length, because a real plug comes up and crumbles.

WHAT IT COSTS

The most honest to the material and the most characterful. The gaps are the risk: they close up in embroidery and at small size the core can read as a dotted line.

03 Section outline

CORE TREATMENT 3 OF 4



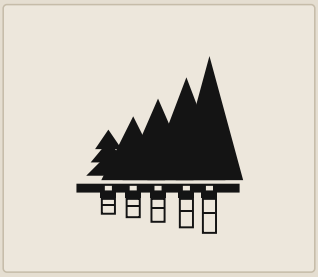
PINE GROUND



BONE GROUND



TONAL GREY



ONE INK — NO TONES

WHAT IT IS

Drawn in outline rather than filled, like a sample in a section drawing, with one seam across it.

WHAT IT COSTS

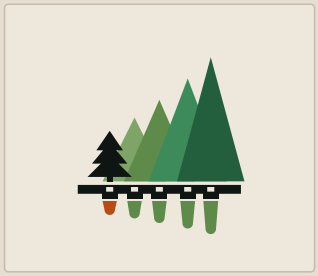
Keeps all the visual weight in the peaks and makes the drawing feel measured. Thin strokes are the first thing lost on a vehicle magnet or a thermal receipt.

04 Soft taper

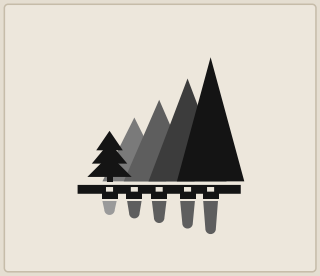
CORE TREATMENT 4 OF 4



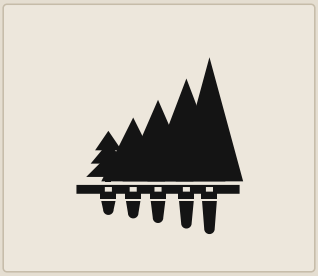
PINE GROUND



BONE GROUND



TONAL GREY



ONE INK — NO TONES

WHAT IT IS

A slight taper to a rounded tip, one thatch seam under the turf. The quietest of the four.

WHAT IT COSTS

Closest to the core you would actually pull. It is also the least distinctive — at a glance it is a row of pegs.

The one-ink column is the one to look at, and it reverses the ranking. It is every token set to the same black — what an embroiderer, a vinyl cutter and a thermal receipt printer actually receive. The tile beside it labelled "tonal grey" is *not* one colour: it is five greys, which is five thread colours and five vinyl layers.

03 survives best, because an outline generates its own separation instead of borrowing it from tone — the opposite of what its "thin strokes die on a magnet" note predicted, and worth weighing against it. **02 also holds**: its gaps are knockouts, so they stay. **01 turns into teeth** and **04 into pegs** — both legible, neither interesting.

And a problem that belongs to the mark, not the cores. In one ink the four peaks merge into a single jagged mass and the first form disappears into it, in all four treatments. The tonal ramp is load-bearing: it is what makes five shapes read as five. A real one-colour master will need hairline gaps cut between the peaks — that is a separate drawing, and it is not on this board.

THE FIRST FORM — CONIFER OR HOUSE?

Raised by the team, 23 Sep 2026. **Both versions are drawn to the same apex** (`y=55.5`, height 30.5), so the form's core is the same depth either way and nothing else in the mark moves. Shown on treatment 01; it applies to whichever treatment wins.



CONIFER — AS DRAWN



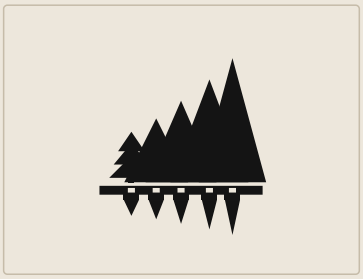
HOUSE — AS ASKED FOR



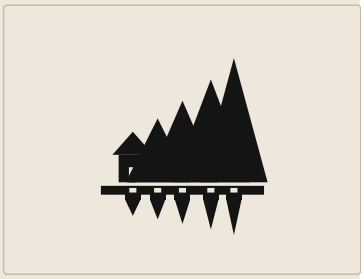
CONIFER, BONE



HOUSE, BONE



CONIFER, ONE INK



HOUSE, ONE INK

THE CASE FOR IT

It names the customer. Sixfold works on residential property, and a house says that in a way a tree does not — a tree could be forestry, utilities or a parks contract. It is also the most legible shape in the set at a glance.

THE CASE AGAINST IT

Four things, and the third is the one that is hard to argue with.

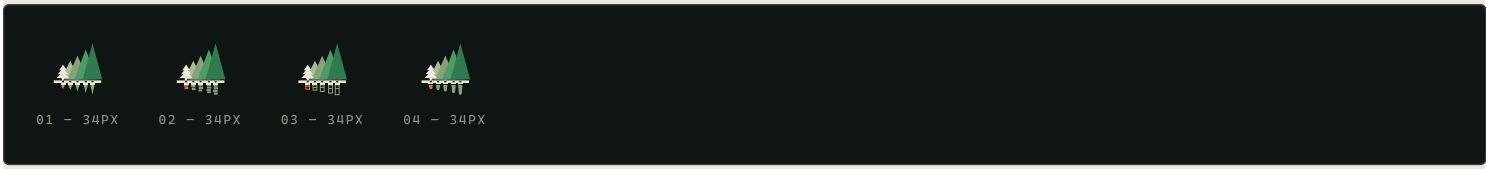
OBJECTION	WEIGHT
It re-centres the story we are moving away from. A house on a ridge with trees around it is the defensible-space picture — it is the wildfire pamphlet's cover. The whole point of this rebrand is that fire stops being the headline.	Heavy. This works directly against the brief.

A house is the most crowded symbol in home services. Roofing, HVAC, plumbing, solar, pest control, remodelling, real estate, mortgage and insurance all use one. The prior-use screen found nothing resembling the Ridge mark; a house would put the mark into a very populated field.	Heavy, and it has a legal edge — distinctiveness is what a registration rests on.
It breaks the logic the mark runs on. Every form above the line has a core below it, as deep as that form is tall. That reads because the forms are things growing out of ground you can core. *You do not core a house.* The core under the house is the one element in the drawing that stops making sense.	Heaviest. Everything else is taste; this is the mark contradicting itself.
The conifer is doing a job. It is what makes the four shapes behind it read as a treeline rather than as mountains. Swap it for a house and the peaks go back to being mountains, which is where the fire read came from.	Moderate. Visible in the tiles above — worth looking before deciding.

> **If the team wants the house anyway, there is a version that does not fight the mark:** put the house *on* the turf band as context rather than as one of the five counted forms, and leave the conifer where it is. Five forms, five cores, logic intact — and the house sits in the scene rather than in the system. That is a different drawing and is not on this board yet; say the word and it gets drawn.

THE SMALL-SIZE TEST

A favicon is 32px and an embroidered left-chest logo is about the same in thread. This row usually decides it — a treatment that dissolves here costs a second, simplified mark to maintain forever.



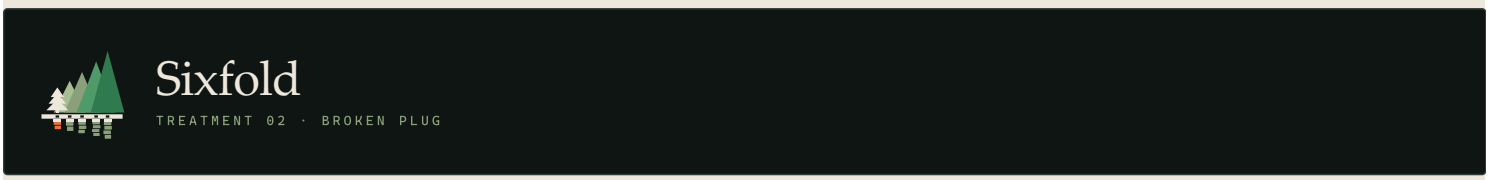


Treatment 1 holds best, which is what geometry buys. Treatment 2's gaps close and it starts to read as a dashed line. Treatment 3's strokes thin out and go grey. Treatment 4 survives but flattens into pegs.

LOCKED UP WITH THE WORDMARK

The wordmark does not change: Palatino, tight tracking, as now. Only the core beside it moves.





Sixfold

TREATMENT 03 · SECTION OUTLINE

Sixfold

TREATMENT 04 · SOFT TAPER

PALETTE — STILL OPEN, AND INDEPENDENT OF THIS

Any treatment can wear any of these. Ordered by what they cost to roll out.

A — Demote the ember



No new colours beyond one deeper green. Moss becomes primary and Ember drops to an accent. **Costs least** — existing tokens keep their names.

B — Turf primary



A four-step green ramp, no warm colour at all. The most decisive break from fire. **The risk is blandness** — green-only is what most lawn companies look like.

C — Turf and wheat



Greens plus a dry-grass gold doing ember's old job. Keeps a warm note without pointing at fire. **Watch the gold** — `#C9A44C` is `1.92:1` on Bone, so large shapes only.

COLOUR	HEX	ON PINE	ON BONE	STANDING
Pine Black	`#0E1512`	–	15.60	Unchanged
Bone	`#EDE7DC`	15.60	–	Unchanged
Sage	`#A7BE93`	9.19	1.64	New — dark grounds only
Moss	`#8AA07A`	6.51	2.31	Unchanged, promoted
Turf, dark ground	`#4E9A68`	5.42	2.78	New
Turf, light ground	`#2F7A4F`	3.54	4.25	New — the anchor
Wheat (C only)	`#C9A44C`	7.84	1.92	New
Ember	`#E4703A`	5.89	2.56	Kept, demoted to accent

Ratios are WCAG contrast, computed rather than estimated. Ember against Moss is `1.11:1` and green on green is `1.20:1` — both separated by hue alone, invisible to a red-green colourblind viewer and gone entirely in one colour. Everything here separates by lightness instead.

OPEN DECISIONS

QUESTION	WHY IT IS OPEN	WHOSE CALL
Which core treatment	What this board is for. Worth doing on paper and at arm's length, not on a screen.	Team, then Brandon

Should the mark encode six at all?	**The Ridge mark has five forms and has never encoded the name.** Making it genuinely six means adding a sixth form above the ground line, which changes the silhouette rather than the cores. Bigger than this board, and it is the one change that would make the drawing say “Sixfold” out loud.	Team, then Brandon
The descriptor — “Land & Fire”	Settled 15 Sep 2026 and already on the crew shirt and every business card option. It names the service being demoted and misses both being promoted. Needs re-opening whether or not the mark changes.	Matthew
Which palette	Independent of the drawing. A costs least; B is the cleanest break; C keeps a warm note.	Team

WHAT A CHANGE COSTS TO ROLL OUT

Not an argument against doing it — an argument for deciding once. Counted in the repository on 23 Sep 2026:

WHAT	COUNT	NOTE
Files carrying the ember hex or the Ridge geometry	180	Sources, generators, copy and stylesheets
Rendered brand PNGs	40	Social and Square sets; both regenerate from one script each
PDFs across the project	84	Includes the 25-PDF team share, which has to be rebuilt as a set
Vehicle magnet artwork	3	24×12, 24×12 light, 24×18 — the repo shows no order placed

> **The live site is the one that matters.** sixfoldcolorado.com went live on 21 Sep 2026 and carries the mark in the favicon, the stylesheet and the wildfire guide page. A mark change means a re-bundle and re-upload, and the host serves a stale cache after an upload — so it has to be cache-busted and verified, not assumed.
>
> There is a precedent for the sweep: the phone-number change in September touched 57 files and 21 PDFs and came out clean. **Check the vehicle magnets have not been ordered before anyone commits** — it is the one item on this list that cannot be re-run.

WHAT HAPPENS AFTER THE MEETING

1. Team picks a core treatment, and separately a palette.
2. The winner gets drawn as a real master: full colour, one colour, and a flat print version with the overlaps resolved — the same three files Ridge already has.
3. Prior-use screen re-run against the new drawing. The existing screen covered the Ridge mark only, and two of its checks were never run — reverse image search and the USPTO design-code search.
4. Palette tokens updated in one place, then the generators re-run and the PDFs re-counted.
5. Site re-bundled and cache-busted last, once everything else matches.

Nothing in this document has been published, posted or uploaded, and no master files have been overwritten. The current Ridge mark and its four SVGs are untouched.

FACT-CHECK AND PROVENANCE LOG

CLAIM	STANDING

Aeration means lawn / core aeration	**Confirmed by Matthew, 23 Sep 2026.** Supersedes the README entry recording it as unestablished; that file has been corrected.
Positioning: aeration and landscaping lead, fire mitigation still offered	**Stated by Matthew, 23 Sep 2026.** Not yet reflected anywhere else in the project.
What core aeration equipment actually is	**Verified first-party, 23 Sep 2026**, against UMass Amherst Extension. Hollow tines are open-ended steel tubes of 1/4–3/4″ inside diameter on a drum or cam-driven head — a punch, not a drill and not an auger. Set in grids from 2″×2″ to 4″×6″, so a real head carries dozens, not five.
Where the extracted plugs end up	**Verified first-party, 23 Sep 2026.** Plugs are 2–3″ long and are deposited *on the surface*, then broken up as topdressing. **So this mark is a cross-section, not a photograph** — a real plug does not hang under the turf. Deliberate, and it is what buys the mirrored ledge.
The turf cap on each core	**From the same source.** A plug comes out with the sward attached, which is the one feature that reads as "aeration core". It takes the band's colour because it is the same turf. A Sage cap on a Moss body tested at `1.20:1` and did not read.
How many forms the Ridge mark has	**Counted off the path data, 23 Sep 2026**, after Matthew spotted six cores under five forms: **five** — four peaks and one conifer. Apex heights 30.5 / 38 / 48 / 60 / 72 units, measured. An earlier hand-estimate of one height was 7 against a real 12; sample the geometry rather than eyeballing it.
All contrast ratios in this document	**Computed**, not estimated — WCAG 2.x relative luminance against the stated hex pairs.
Colourblind separation figures	**Simulated** with a standard deuteranopia matrix. Enough to reject a pairing, not a substitute for showing it to someone.
The new colours: Turf, Sage, Wheat	**Invented for this document.** My proposals, not anything previously agreed, with no standing until the team picks one.
Asset counts — 180 / 40 / 84 / 3	**Counted in the repo, 23 Sep 2026.** The 180 is a text match on the ember hex or the Ridge path data, so it will include false positives in dated fact-check entries.
The 57-file phone sweep precedent	**Project record**, committed September 2026.
Vehicle magnets not yet ordered	**Unresolved.** The repo holds the artwork and an order sheet and shows no order. Absence of evidence — somebody has to confirm it.